CONTENT SYSTEMS.AI

The support handoff map

The 5 moments a support bot must hand the customer to a person. Set them before Black Friday, not after the first bad review.

What it looks like when it works

ANSWERED BY AI

72 in 100

Support tickets, in 4 languages, at an apparel brand we work with in Berlin.

SENT TO A PERSON

28 in 100

On purpose. These are the 5 moments on page 2.

CANCELLATIONS KEPT

1 in 4

Of customers who tried to cancel stayed, at the same brand.

Why the handoff matters

55 vs 26

In every 100 people, 55 trust AI to fix their issue when they know a person is reachable. Without that option, only 26 do.[1] The handoff isn't a failure of the bot. It's why people use it.

1 Five9 survey of 3,000 consumers, via Retail Dive, Oct 22 2026, retaildive.com/news/why-customers-fed-up-ai-chatbots/833488

Skip the handoff and people stop trusting the bot.

The 5 moments

For each: what the bot listens for, what it says, and what the person picking it up gets. The customer should never have to repeat themselves.

☐ 01 An angry customer

LISTEN FOR
A 2nd complaint on the same order, all caps, "this is the 3rd time", a threat to leave a review or dispute the charge.

THE BOT SAYS
"I'm sorry this has gone wrong. I'm passing you to a person now, with everything you've told me."

THE PERSON GETS
The order, the full chat, what's been tried, and a note that the customer is upset.

☐ 02 Someone who wants to cancel

LISTEN FOR
Cancel, stop my subscription, close my account, return everything.

THE BOT SAYS
"Before anything changes, someone from our team will take this. They can already see your order."

THE PERSON GETS
Order history, the reason given, and what they're allowed to offer to keep the customer.

☐ 03 A refund over your limit

LISTEN FOR
A refund above the amount you set, a 2nd refund request, a high-value order, a damaged item.

THE BOT SAYS
"This needs a quick check from our team. You'll hear back by [time]."

THE PERSON GETS
The amount, the order, the policy line that applies, and past refunds for this customer.

☐ 04 A question the bot isn't sure about

LISTEN FOR
No clear answer in your policies, anything about safety or allergies, a promise your policy doesn't cover.

THE BOT SAYS
"I don't want to guess on this. A person will answer you by [time]."

THE PERSON GETS
The question, what the bot found, and exactly where it got stuck.

☐ 05 Anyone who asks for a human

LISTEN FOR
Human, real person, agent, call me. Asked once is enough.

THE BOT SAYS
"Of course. Connecting you now." No arguing, no "let me try 1 more thing".

THE PERSON GETS
The full chat and the order, so they start where the bot stopped.

Set your map before peak

Fill in a name and a reply time for each moment. If nobody owns a moment, the customer waits.

MOMENT	YOUR TRIGGER OR LIMIT	PICKED UP BY
01 · An angry customer	_____	
02 · Wants to cancel	_____	
03 · Refund over your limit	Over $_____	_____
04 · Bot isn't sure	_____	
05 · Asks for a human	Every time, first ask	_____

A good handoff, every time

- [ ] The customer never repeats their order number or their problem.
- [ ] The bot says when they'll hear back, and the time is true.
- [ ] Out of hours, it says so plainly, and gives the time someone will reply.
- [ ] Peak weekends have a named person on handoffs, not "whoever's around".
- [ ] Once a week, someone reads 10 handoffs and fixes what the bot could have answered.

Want a support system where the hard ones always reach a person?

Content Systems.ai builds support systems for e-commerce brands that answer the routine questions, hand the rest to your team with the full story attached, and keep a person on every refund and cancellation. We build on the help desk you already use, and you own what we build. Tell us about your store and we'll send a free quote with your top AI opportunities.

contentsystems.ai/ecommerce